being the state of the case can I ask of him a present further advance? I hope very very soon to get home some funds to meet pressing engagements but for the present the matter must rest where it is. Tell George I have been dreadfully hurried with all kinds of business as not to have been able to find a moment to write him but next weeks post will bring a full letter from me.

I am writing in a room full of Persians and do not know what I am saying. In the meantime God bless you all.

[CHARLES BURGESS? *no date.*]

(A single sheet which was removed from a bound volume by Mrs. Thomas F. Burgess in December, 1938, it being the only page in the volume that was not blank. The paper bears the J. Whatman watermark of 1834. The handwriting is that of Charles H. Burgess.[38])

yet been able to induce his people to consent to his plan of giving the rivers with Chereekund to the Russian powers. Poolut Khan of Cera Papā an independent Turkuman chief who possesses Salt mines and has considerable power is decidedly opposed to Khayat Khan's ideas. His country is about 10 fursangs from Chereekund. Fortunately the Turkumans stood firm to Meer Ibrahim Khan's interest in the rivers and the Colonel and Mirza Alexander returned without effecting anything. The Russians have been driven this Summer from the Fort of Mangurklak by the Kozakas or Tartars after a seige of 22 days; it was defended by 200 men and six pieces of cannon; of the former 60 succeeded in making their escape in boats.

About 2 months since a Russian cutter of war was taken near Astrachan by the Turkuman boats. She mounted 4 guns and had 45 men on board; the commander has been ransomed at a high rate, the men are either killed or sold

[38] This appears to be a memorandum of the type which went into the "letters" to Mr. Villiers, Lord Ponsonby, and the Duke of Richmond, cf. Appendices. Briefly, the political situation referred to derives from the humiliating treaty of Adrianople (1829) forced upon Mahmud II by the victorious Russians. As a consequence of Turkish concessions, Russia conceived it her privilege to take over the entire Caucasus. A long period of guerilla warfare with the wild tribes ensued, frequently to the discredit of Russian arms, cf. especially the nearly contemporaneous record of events in the *Revue de l'Orient,* 1844, série 1, tome 1, p. 257–291, *Études sur la Circassie,* by Alphonse Denis, and série 1, tome 4 p. 150–166, 261–287, *Situation des Russes dans le Caucase,* by Ignace Xavier Hommaire de Hell. Military outposts and even forts, like the one described in this note were repeatedly cut off and stormed, and even Russian shipping was at times attacked. The names Poolut Khan and Khayat Khan are presumably those of local chiefs. Mir Ibrahim Khan seems to have been a Russophile Persian. Mirza Alexander, or rather, Mirza Mohammed Ali Kazem Beg was a Persian who had been converted to Protestantism by an Anglican mission. He spent most of his life in Russian service, became a noted Oriental scholar and has to his credit many works on the languages, literatures, etc., of the Near East. Count Simonich was the Russian envoy to the court of Persia. Mir Abu Talib would seem to have been the Persian ambassador (?) or special commissioner to St. Petersburg.

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